

3.1 Choosing A Hosting Platform

Once you decide that you want to set up a Web site, the very first step you need to look at is buying a domain and checking out the hosting options available to you. Where you buy the hosting from is secondary right now, as the major decision depends on what type of hosting you need and the platform (Windows or Linux), on which you need to host.

The first step in this exercise is to decide the contents of your site, and understand the limitations of each platform and the costs involved.

The simplest, and cheapest, option is to opt for Linux hosting running a PHP/MySQL site that will give you the database driven online presence you need and also some cool options for automatically setting up a site. Using PHP-Nuke, you can set up a site for only the cost of the domain name and Web hosting. A detailed 'How To' is provided in the next chapter.

Other than a PHP/MySQL site, you can choose to set up a sim-

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You can use PHP to build a great Web site using only Open Source tools